

ATTAWAT ASSAVANADDA (馬臣義)

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ACADEMIC PROFILE

Political scientist working at the intersection of international relations, political communication, political psychology, and global media, with a regional focus on China and Southeast Asia. My research examines how identity, narratives, and strategic communication shape foreign-public attitudes and international relations. I received my PhD in Political Science from The University of Hong Kong and am an Associate Fellow of Advance HE (UK).

EDUCATION

PhD, Political Science, The University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong SAR, 2026
MA, International Relations, Waseda University, Japan, 2020
BA (Honours), Political Science, Chulalongkorn University, Thailand, 2017

RESEARCH AND PUBLICATIONS

Revise and Resubmit

- “‘Yes, we are family, but ...’: Thai receptions of ‘Thai-China are the same family’ narrative.”
International Journal of Strategic Communication.
- “Is Soft Power a Zero-sum Competition?” With Austin Strange and Samuel Chan.
International Studies Quarterly.

Under Review

- “Three-dimensional outcomes of moral-identity branding in foreign political marketing: Experimental evidence from China’s public diplomacy in Thailand.”
- “What does China’s rise mean to ethnic Chinese overseas? A qualitative study of Sino-Thais.”
- “Hearts and minds across borders: Chinese ethnic identity and political support for China in Thailand.”

Work-in-progress

- “China’s digital public diplomacy in the Global South: State of the field and ways forward.” Book chapter proposal submitted for the *Research Handbook on Communication in China*.
- “Cultural Outreach and Political Agenda: How Thai Publics Receive China’s Public Diplomacy Messaging.” Accepted for presentation at Hong Kong Chu Hai College, 21 November 2026.
- “From Public Diplomacy to Publicised Diplomacy: China’s Digital Diplomacy during Bilateral Tensions in Southeast Asia.” With Mon Madomitsu and Maria Elize H. Mendoza.
- “Who are we to each other? Conceptualising discursive construction of interstate bilateral relations.” With Gao Xirui

Policy and other writing

- “Soft power, deterrence, and South Korea’s national security,” in *Shaping the Future of Security on the Korean Peninsula: Next-Generation Policy Perspectives*. New York: National Committee on American Foreign Policy, 2025.
- “Thailand’s Brain Drain Challenge: Trends and Implications,” *Issues & Insights* Vol. 23, SR6. Honolulu, HI: Pacific Forum, 2023.
- Review of China’s Asian Dream: Empire Building along the New Silk Road by Tom Miller. *International Journal of China Studies* 9(2), 2018.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

The University of Hong Kong — School of Future Media

Tutor, CCCH9062 Encoding and Decoding China in International News, Spring 2025–26

(with Prof. Alejandro Reyes)

- **Overall Tutoring Effectiveness: 93.6%**; 118 enrolled students.
- Designed and implemented activity-based classes developing media literacy and critical thinking through analysis of global media reporting on China.
- Mentored student presentations and teamwork through training, rehearsals, group projects, and discussion.

The University of Hong Kong — Department of Politics and Public Administration

Tutor, POLI3052 International Relations of East Asia, Spring 2022–23

(with Prof. Enze Han)

- **Overall Tutoring Effectiveness: 86.4%**; 104 enrolled students.
- Designed and implemented discussion-based classes using current research on East Asian international relations and current research to contemporary East Asian issues.
- Developed students' communication, debate, and research skills through group discussion and short quizzes.

Teaching Certifications

- Associate Fellow, Advance HE (UK)
- HKU Certificate in Teaching and Learning in Higher Education.

SELECTED CONFERENCES, TALKS, AND WORKSHOPS

- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2024, 2025, 2026.
- International Studies Association Annual Convention, 2025, 2026.
- International Studies Association Asia-Pacific Conference, 2023; 2026 (accepted).
- International Political Science Association World Congress, 2025.
- Selected workshops: SEAREG (2025); APSA Southeast Asia Research Development Group (2024, 2025); ASEAS-UK PhD Workshop (2025); CUHK Workshop on Political Psychology in East Asia (2024).
- Selected policy symposia: Manila Dialogue on the South China Sea (2024); Pacific Forum Research Showcase (2024); NCAFP Next-Generation Korean Peninsula Specialists (2024); US-ASEAN Futures Symposium (2023).

SCHOLARSHIPS, AWARDS, AND ACADEMIC TRAINING

Major Scholarships and Awards

- HKU Postgraduate Scholarship, 2021–2025.
- Japanese Government Scholarship (MEXT), 2018–2020.
- SEAREG Fellowship, 2025 (full sponsorship).
- Selected additional awards and support: APSA SEA-RDG awards (2024, 2025); HKU travel and departmental support; NCAFP sponsorship (2024); Hong Kong Government Reaching Out Award (2023); IPSA Travel Grant (2023); Haraguchi Memorial Asia Research Fund Research Grant (2019).

Major Scholarships and Awards

- Short-term Visiting PhD Student, University of British Columbia, 2025 (hosted by Kai Ostwald).
- IPSA Pre-Conference Methods Workshop, "Text as Data," 2025.
- IPSA–NUS Methods School, "Modern Regression Analysis," 2024.
- HKU Methods Hub, "Quantitative Data Analysis in the Social Sciences," 2024.
- HKU Graduate School, Qualitative Research Methods Workshops, 2024.
- IPSA–NUS Methods School, "Survey Research" and "Mixed Methods Research," 2023.
- New York University Shanghai, "Introduction to Computational Social Science," 2023.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2020–2021	Research Assistant, German-Southeast Asian Center of Excellence for Public Policy and Good Governance, Thammasat University
2018	Research Assistant, Chinese Studies Centre, Institute of Asian Studies, Chulalongkorn University
2017–2018	Political Analyst, Government House of Thailand, Office of the Advisor to the Deputy Prime Minister for Security Affairs
2016	Research Intern, The University of New South Wales

EXTERNAL AFFILIATIONS AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

2021–Present	Pacific Forum — Young Leader
2024–2025	National Committee on American Foreign Policy — Next-Generation Korean Peninsula Specialist
2022–2023	Young China Watchers International — Global Editorial Team

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND MEMBERSHIPS

Reviewer:	Review of International Studies.
Memberships:	APSA, IPSA, ISA, ASEAS-UK, International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP), Association for Asian Studies (AAS).

METHODS, SOFTWARE, AND LANGUAGES

Methods:	survey and experimental research; regression analysis; mixed methods; interviews and qualitative research; thematic analysis; computational social science; text-as-data.
Software:	RStudio, Stata, SPSS, Qualtrics XM.
Languages:	Thai (native); English (professional); Mandarin Chinese (upper intermediate); Cantonese (conversational); Japanese (conversational).
Fieldwork and research travel:	Taiwan (2020); Thailand (February and July–August 2024).

REFEREES

Austin Strange	Assoc. Prof., The University of Hong Kong astrange@hku.hk
Dov Levin	Assoc. Prof., The University of Hong Kong dovlvn@hku.hk
Kai Ostwald	Assoc. Prof., University of British Columbia kai.ostwald@ubc.ca
Soo Yeon Kim	Assoc. Prof., University of British Columbia sooyeon.kim@ubc.ca
Enze Han	Assoc. Prof., The University of Hong Kong enzehan@hku.hk (also Teaching Referee)
Alejandro Reyes	Adjunct Professor, The University of Hong Kong reyes@hku.hk (only Teaching Referee)